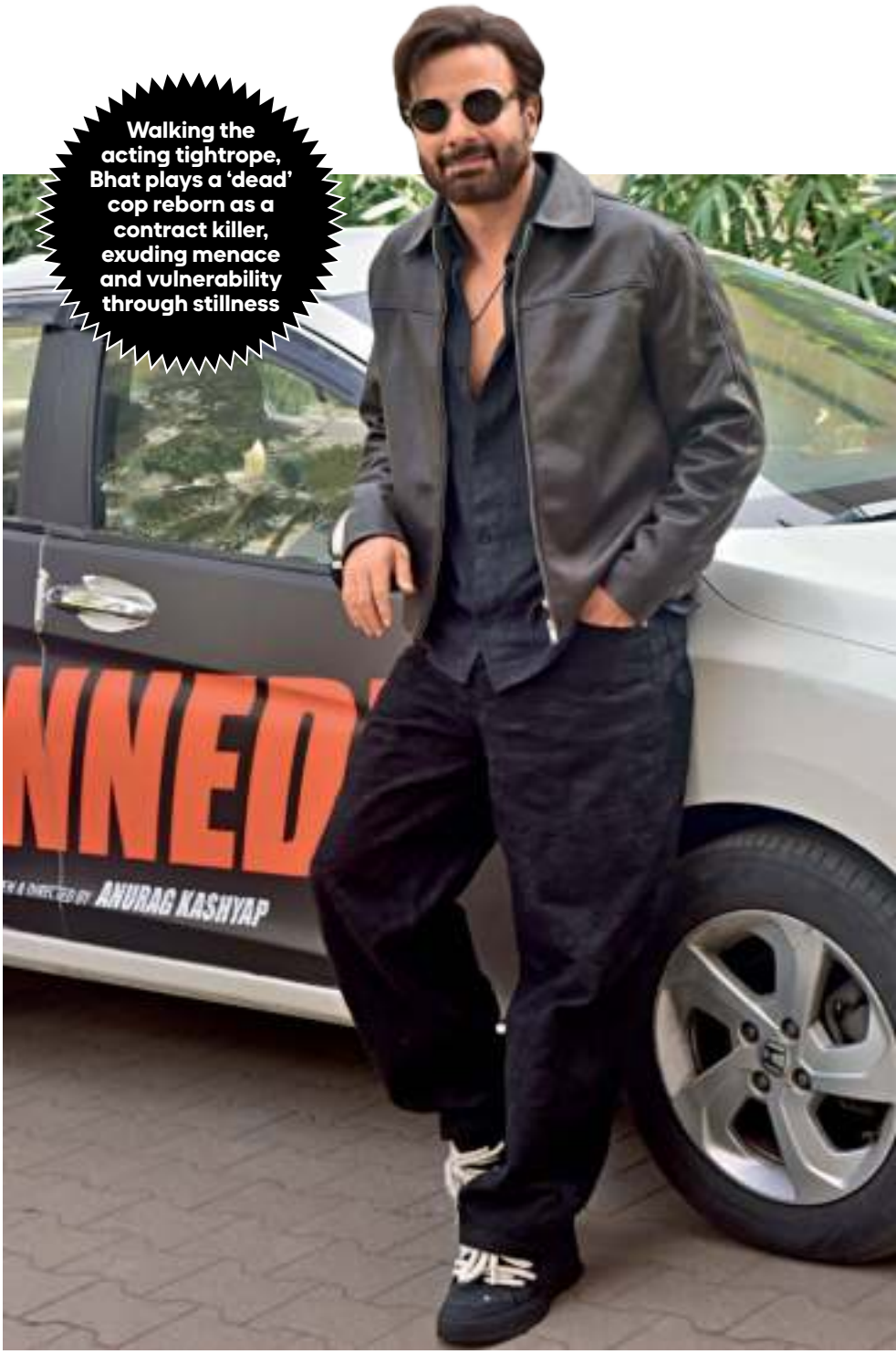
CINEMA ▼

DARK TURN

ACTOR *RAHUL BHAT* ON PLAYING THE EPONYMOUS KENNEDY IN ANURAG KASHYAP'S COVID-ERA CRIME THRILLER



Walking the acting tightrope, Bhat plays a 'dead' cop reborn as a contract killer, exuding menace and vulnerability through stillness

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Three years after Anurag Kashyap's *Kennedy* premiered at Cannes, the film has finally released in India. For actor Rahul Bhat, who plays the titular character, the wait has been an exercise in patience. "After getting so much validation at Cannes, there were moments of impatience that the film wasn't reaching its audience, but as an actor there was nothing I could do. All I could focus on is my work," he says. This clarity has been the cornerstone of Bhat's career, be it Anurag Kashyap's *Ugly* (2014) or last year's Netflix series, *Black Warrant* (2025).

In *Kennedy*, Bhat plays a former cop named Uday Shetty who is dead on paper. In reality, though, he's turned into a sleepless contract killer operating under the alias Kennedy. "He's someone who has seen and experienced so much that he survives on instincts rather than hope. As a product of the system, he is complicit but also trapped." As he blackmails, extorts and kills for his unofficial